

D444

Adult Health I

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A patient with heart failure, who owns a small hardware store and whose wife packs his lunches, weighed 82.0 kg yesterday morning and 84.0 kg this morning on the same scale. About how much fluid has he retained?

- A. About 2 liters
- B. About 84 liters
- C. None; overnight gain is from food
- D. About 4.4 liters

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient receiving IV diuretics loses 1.5 L of fluid overnight. About how much should the morning weight change?

- A. A decrease of about 3.3 kg
- B. No change until the next day
- C. A decrease of about 1.5 kg
- D. An increase of about 1.5 kg

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 40-year-old line cook, who was burned by hot oil at the start of a double shift, has partial-thickness burns over the entire front of the trunk and the entire right arm. He is right-handed. Using the rule of nines, what percentage of body surface is burned?

- A. 18%
- B. 36%
- C. 45%
- D. 27%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which single burned area equals 18% of adult body surface under the rule of nines?

- A.** The whole trunk, front and back
- B.** One entire arm
- C.** The head and neck
- D.** One entire leg

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A 66-year-old retired farmer with suspected pneumonia, who arrived by ambulance at 0200, has orders for blood cultures and a first dose of IV ceftriaxone. The lab is running 20 minutes behind. What should the nurse do?

- A.** Hold the antibiotic until culture results return.
- B.** Draw the blood cultures, then give the antibiotic right away.
- C.** Give the antibiotic first, then draw cultures.
- D.** Wait for the lab to draw the cultures, even if it takes hours.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A 25-year-old with asthma, who teaches yoga and uses a fluticasone inhaler daily, starts wheezing and says her chest is tight after a fire alarm drill outdoors in cold air. Which inhaler should she use now?

- A.** Albuterol
- B.** Fluticasone, because she uses it daily
- C.** Either one; all inhalers treat asthma the same way
- D.** Two puffs of each, fluticasone first

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A patient taking ibuprofen for back pain, who manages an apartment building, reports two days of black, sticky stools and feels dizzy when standing. He says he ate blueberries last week. His heart rate is 112. What is the nurse's priority?

- A. Tell him the color is from the blueberries.
- B. Give another dose of ibuprofen for his back pain.
- C. Assess vital signs fully, keep him safe from falls, and notify the provider of a possible GI bleed.
- D. Collect a stool sample tomorrow for routine testing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A patient with cirrhosis, who used to drive a delivery truck and likes crossword puzzles, is on lactulose and had three soft stools today. He asks the nurse to stop the medicine because he is tired of going to the bathroom. What should the nurse explain?

- A. The drug can be stopped now that he has had stools.
- B. Lactulose is only for constipation, so it is not needed.
- C. Any number of stools means the dose is too high.
- D. The stools show the drug is working to lower ammonia and protect his thinking.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Why is lactulose given to a patient with hepatic encephalopathy?

- A. To raise blood ammonia
- B. To lower blood ammonia by trapping it in the bowel for removal
- C. To reduce fluid in the abdomen
- D. To treat constipation from opioid use

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

The morning after a thyroidectomy, a patient who is a church choir director and has a raspy voice says her lips and fingertips are tingling. Her husband thinks she is just nervous. What should the nurse suspect?

- A.** Thyroid storm
- B.** Low calcium from parathyroid injury
- C.** Anxiety that needs reassurance only
- D.** High calcium from the surgery

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A 58-year-old with diabetes, who enjoys fishing and has a family history of diabetes, has missed three clinic visits. He says the bus no longer runs near his home and he does not own a car. Which factor is a social determinant of health?

- A.** His love of fishing
- B.** His family history of diabetes
- C.** Lack of reliable transportation
- D.** His age of 58

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which finding is a biological risk factor rather than a social determinant of health?

- A.** Inherited sickle cell trait
- B.** Limited health literacy tied to schooling
- C.** Living in an area with no grocery store
- D.** Unstable housing

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A patient with heart failure, ~~who owns a small hardware store and whose wife packs his lunches~~, weighed 82.0 kg yesterday morning and 84.0 kg this morning on the same scale. About how much fluid has he retained?

Target word: fluid retained **Decides:** 2 kg gained $\approx$ 2 L of fluid.

A	Correct	1 kg $\approx$ 1 L; he gained 2 kg.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses today's weight instead of the change.
C	Adjacent category	Rapid weight change reflects fluid, not tissue.
D	Confusion set	Converts kg to pounds and treats pounds as liters.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A patient receiving IV diuretics loses 1.5 L of fluid overnight. About how much should the morning weight change?

Target word: solve for weight change **Decides:** 1 L $\approx$ 1 kg.

A	Confusion set	Converts liters to pounds and calls it kilograms.
B	Dropped element	Drops the direct link between fluid and weight.
C	Correct	Fluid loss of 1.5 L $\approx$ 1.5 kg lost.
D	Inverted operation	Fluid loss lowers weight.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A 40-year-old line cook, ~~who was burned by hot oil at the start of a double shift~~, has partial-thickness burns over the entire front of the trunk and the entire right arm. ~~He is right handed~~. Using the rule of nines, what percentage of body surface is burned?

Target word: total burned % **Decides:** Front trunk 18% + one arm 9%.

A	Dropped element	Counts the trunk but drops the arm.
B	Inverted operation	Doubles the arm to 18%, the value for a leg.
C	Confusion set	Counts the whole trunk (36%) instead of the front only.
D	Correct	$18 + 9 = 27\%$.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

Which single burned area equals 18% of adult body surface under the rule of nines?

Target word: reverse: from % to area **Decides:** Each leg = 18%.

A	Inverted operation	That is 36%.
B	Confusion set	Each arm is 9%.
C	Adjacent category	The head is 9%.
D	Correct	Each leg is 18%.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A 66-year-old ~~retired farmer~~ with suspected pneumonia, ~~who arrived by ambulance at 0200,~~ has orders for blood cultures and a first dose of IV ceftriaxone. ~~The lab is running 20 minutes behind.~~ What should the nurse do?

Target word: sequence of culture and antibiotic **Decides:** Cultures before the first dose, without long delay.

A	Absolute language	Results take days; treatment should not wait.
B	Correct	Cultures first keep results accurate; the antibiotic then starts promptly.
C	Inverted operation	Antibiotics before cultures can cause false-negative results.
D	Camouflage	Leans on the lab delay; the nurse can draw or escalate so the antibiotic is not held long.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A 25-year-old with asthma, ~~who teaches yoga~~ and uses a fluticasone inhaler daily, starts wheezing and says her chest is tight ~~after a fire alarm drill outdoors in cold air.~~ Which inhaler should she use now?

Target word: rescue inhaler **Decides:** Acute symptoms need a short-acting beta agonist.

A	Correct	A short-acting bronchodilator opens airways within minutes.
B	Adjacent category	A controller steroid does not relieve an acute attack.
C	Absolute language	They work differently and at different speeds.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses priority; the rescue drug comes first.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A patient taking ibuprofen for back pain, ~~who manages an apartment building,~~ reports two days of black, sticky stools and feels dizzy when standing. ~~He says he ate blueberries last week.~~ His heart rate is 112. What is the nurse's priority?

Target word: interpret and act **Decides:** Black tarry stool + dizziness + tachycardia on an NSAID = GI bleed.

A	Camouflage	Leans on the diet detail and ignores the rising pulse and dizziness.
B	Inverted operation	NSAIDs can cause and worsen GI bleeding.
C	Correct	The signs point to bleeding with low volume.
D	Dropped element	Drops the urgent vital-sign changes.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A patient with cirrhosis, ~~who used to drive a delivery truck and likes crossword puzzles,~~ is on lactulose and had three soft stools today. He asks the nurse to stop the medicine because he is tired of going to the bathroom. What should the nurse explain?

Target word: lactulose goal **Decides:** 2-3 soft stools a day is the goal.

A	Inverted operation	Stopping lets ammonia rise again.
B	Adjacent category	In liver disease its main purpose is lowering ammonia.
C	Absolute language	Only excessive diarrhea signals a problem.
D	Correct	Lactulose clears ammonia through the gut; 2-3 soft stools is the target.

9. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

Why is lactulose given to a patient with hepatic encephalopathy?

Target word: reverse: purpose of the drug **Decides:** It lowers ammonia.

A	Inverted operation	The goal is the opposite.
B	Correct	Less ammonia means less confusion.
C	Adjacent category	That is the role of diuretics or paracentesis for ascites.
D	Confusion set	A different use of laxatives.

10. Answer B Concept 7

The morning after a thyroidectomy, a patient ~~who is a church choir director and has a raspy voice~~ says her lips and fingertips are tingling. ~~Her husband thinks she is just nervous.~~ What should the nurse suspect?

Target word: cause of tingling **Decides:** Parathyroid injury → hypocalcemia.

A	Confusion set	Presents with fever and rapid heart rate, not tingling.
B	Correct	Tingling around the mouth and fingers is a classic sign of hypocalcemia.
C	Camouflage	Leans on the husband's comment.
D	Inverted operation	Parathyroid damage lowers calcium.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A 58-year-old with diabetes, ~~who enjoys fishing and has a family history of diabetes,~~ has missed three clinic visits. He says the bus no longer runs near his home and he does not own a car. Which factor is a social determinant of health?

Target word: identify SDOH **Decides:** Transportation access is a social condition.

A	Camouflage	A hobby detail, not a barrier to care.
B	Adjacent category	Genetic risk is biological, not social.
C	Correct	Access to transportation is a condition of where he lives.
D	Confusion set	Age is a biological factor.

12. Answer A Concept 8 • transfer

Which finding is a biological risk factor rather than a social determinant of health?

Target word: reverse: pick the non-SDOH **Decides:** Genetics is biological.

A	Correct	Genes are biological, not social conditions.
B	Confusion set	Education is a social determinant.
C	Inverted operation	Food access is a classic social determinant.
D	Adjacent category	Housing is a social determinant.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Daily weight and fluid	A 1 kg change in body weight over a day or two reflects about 1 L of fluid gained or lost.	Treating overnight weight gain as fat, or confusing kilograms with pounds.	Two daily weights and a question about fluid.
2	Rule of nines for burns	Adult burn surface: head 9%, each arm 9%, front trunk 18%, back trunk 18%, each leg 18%, perineum 1%.	Counting an entire leg as 9% or the whole trunk as 18%.	Burned body areas listed and a percentage asked.
3	Cultures before antibiotics	Obtain ordered cultures before the first antibiotic dose, without delaying the antibiotic.	Giving the antibiotic first or waiting hours for culture results.	New antibiotic order plus pending cultures.
4	Asthma rescue vs. controller	A short-acting beta agonist (albuterol) relieves an acute attack; inhaled corticosteroids control inflammation over time and do not stop an attack.	Reaching for the daily steroid inhaler during an attack.	Acute wheeze or tight chest and a choice of inhalers.
5	Signs of GI bleeding	Coffee-ground vomit, black tarry stools, and dizziness with rising pulse signal GI bleeding that needs quick assessment and reporting.	Blaming dark stools on diet or iron without checking vital signs.	Dark stools or vomit plus a heart-rate or blood-pressure change.
6	Hepatic encephalopathy and lactulose	Lactulose lowers ammonia by trapping it in the gut; the usual goal is about 2–3 soft stools a day.	Treating loose stools as a reason to stop lactulose.	Cirrhosis, confusion, or an ammonia level with lactulose ordered.
7	Post-thyroidectomy hypocalcemia	Damage to the parathyroid glands during thyroid surgery can drop calcium, causing tingling around the mouth and fingers, muscle spasm, and positive Chvostek or Trousseau signs.	Assuming tingling after neck surgery is anxiety or high calcium.	Thyroidectomy plus tingling, twitching, or spasm.
8	Social determinants of health	Social determinants are the conditions where people live, work, and age — income, housing, transportation, food access, education — that shape health risk.	Classifying genetics or age as social determinants.	A barrier to care that comes from circumstances rather than biology.

Course scope (public description): Adult Health I prepares students to provide safe, equitable, high quality medical surgical nursing care for diverse adult populations across the lifespan in various health care settings. This includes health promotion and management of common conditions. This course explores how social determinants of health impact health risk and outcome. This course will focus on medical surgical nursing care related to head & neck, skin, inflammation, infection, fluid & electrolytes, respiratory, gastrointestinal, hepatic, genitourinary, and reproductive systems. The nursing process and the clinical judgement model will be used as the foundation to navigate the management of care for patients. A variety of populations and settings are used in the experiential learning components of this course. Co-requisite: D443.